

Of slouthfulnesse. Chap.xxv. A shrewd wife.

he hath done to mee: I will render to the man according to his worke.

30 I went by the field of the slouthfull, and by the vineyard of the man boyd of vnderstanding:

31 And loe, it was all growen ouer with thornes, and nettles had couered the face thereof, and the stone wall therof was broken downe:

32 Then I saib, and I considered it well, I looked vpon it, and receiued instruction.

33 * Yet a little sleepe, a little slumber, a little folding of the handes to sleepe:

34 So shall thy pouertie come, as one that traucileth, and thy want, as an armed man.

CHAP. XXV.

1 Obseruations about Kings, 8 and about auoyding causes of quarrels, and sundry causes thereof.

These are also Proverbes of Solomon, which the men of hezekiah king of Iudah copied out.

2 It is the glory of God to conceale a thing: but the honour of Kings is to search out a matter.

3 The heauen for height, and the earth for depth, and the heart of Kings is vnsearchable.

4 Take away the drosse from the silver, and there shall come forth a vessel for the finer.

5 * Take away the wicked from before the king, and his throne shall be established in righteousness.

6 † Put not forth thy selfe in the presence of the king, and stand not in the place of great men.

7 * For better it is that it be said vnto thee, Come by hither; then that thou shouldest be put lower in the presence of the Prince whom thine eyes haue seene.

8 Goe not forth hastily to strue, lest thou know not what to doe in the ende thereof, when thy neighbour hath put thee to shame.

9 * Debate thy cause with thy neighbour himselfe; and † discouer not a secret to another:

10 Lest he that heareth it, put thee to shame, and thine infamie turne not away.

11 A word † fitly spoken is like apples of gold in pictures of silver.

12 As an eare-ring of gold, and an ornament of fine gold, so is a wise reprouer vpon an obedient eare.

13 * As the cold of snow in the time of haruest, so is a faithfull messenger to them that send him: for hee refresheth the soule of his masters.

14 Who so boasteth himselfe † of a false gift, is like cloudes and winde without raine.

15 * By long forbearing is a Prince perswaded, and a soft tongue breaketh the bone.

16 Hast thou found hony: eate so much as is sufficient for thee: lest thou be filled therewith, and vomit it.

17 † Withdraw thy foote from thy neighbours house: lest he be † weary of thee, and so hate thee.

18 A man that beareth false witnes against * his neighbour, is a maul, and a sword, and a sharpe arrow.

19 Confidence in an vnfaithfull man in time of trouble, is like a broken tooth, and a foot out of ioynt.

20 As hee that taketh away a garment in cold weather, and as vinegar vpon mire, so is he that singeth songs to an heauy heart.

21 * If thine enemy be hungry, giue him bread to eate: and if hee be thirstie, giue him water to drinke.

22 For thou shalt heape coales of fire vpon his head, and the LORD shall reward thee.

23 † The North winde driueth away raine: so doeth an angrie countenance a backbiting tongue.

24 * It is better to dwell in a corner of the house top, then with a brawling woman, and in a wide house.

25 As cold waters to a thirstie soule: so is good newes from a farre country.

26 A righteous man falling downe before the wicked, is as a troubled fountain, and a corrupt spring.

27 It is not good to eat much hony: so for men to search their owne glory, is not glory.

28 * Hee that hath no rule ouer his owne spirit, is like a citie that is broken downe, and without walles.

CHAP. XXVI.

1 Obseruations about fooles, 13 about slugs, 17 and about contentious bodies.

* Chap. 13. 17.

† Hebr. in a gift of falsehood.

* Chap. 15. 1. gene. 12. 4. and 16. 14. 1 sam. 25. 24.

|| Or, let thy feare be settled in thy neighbours house.

† Hebr. full of thorns.

* Psal. 120. 4. chap. 12. 18.

* Exod. 23. 4. rom. 12. 20.

|| Or, The Northwinde bringeth forth raine, so doeth a backbiting tongue, an angry countenance.

* Chap. 21. 9 and 19. 13.

* Chap. 16. 32.

† Hebr. for my heart.

* Chap. 6. 9 &c.

† H. fr. a man of field.

† H. fr. there is no searching.

* Chap. 20. 8.

† Hebr. for not cut thy glory.

* Luke 14. 10.

* Matth. 5. 25. and 18. 15. || Or, discover not the secret of another.

† Hebr. spoken upon his wheeles.